

New Testament





About the Course

Each year in High School, students read one of the gospels along with several other New Testament epistles. For 2026-2027, they read the gospel of Luke along with Galatians, Philippians, and Colossians. Using their study Bibles and other resources, students encounter scripture and seek to understand the cultural, historical, and theological context of their readings in order to more deeply appreciate the richness of the Bible and the humility needed in order to live out God's word today.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Bible: Grade 9



Placement & Combining Tips

Appropriate for any HS grades. Students new to reading the Bible for themselves or unused to commentaries or study notes may find the lessons in Grades 7-8 a gentler introduction to these study practices.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
9	New Testament: Grade 9 1 time/week 30 min	NIV Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible: Bringing to Life the Ancient World of Scripture Introducing the New Testament: A Historical, Literary, and Theological Survey Luke for Everyone

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Bible: Grade 9				
Bible History: Grade 9	Old Testament: Grades 7-12	New Testament: Grade 9	Old Testament: Grades 7-12	Church History: Grades 7-9



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

New Testament: Grade 9



NIV Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible: Bringing to Life the Ancient World of Scripture



Introducing the New Testament: A Historical, Literary, and Theological Survey



Luke for Everyone



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

(No Quick Links Assigned)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



New Testament: Grade 9

How To Approach



Recap

Take a moment to recall what you read previously in the same book or topic.



Read

Read the passage assigned or read for the number of minutes allocated. If a book is challenging for you, try stopping to narrate to yourself silently now and then to make sure you are tracking. Or you could listen to an audiobook version of the text and read along. You may also want to read aloud to yourself. If a book is an easy read, enjoy the ride! Keep an eye out for quotes to put in your Commonplace Book or events or characters to put down in your Book of Centuries.



Narrate

Process and integrate your reading by narrating either orally or in writing. Some lesson plans will give you a suggestion of how best to narrate. You might want to set a timer to keep yourself on track, so you stop reading with enough time to narrate.



Connect

Read notes in your Study Bible or commentary. Look up places mentioned in the text in your Bible atlas. Add something to your Book of Centuries or Commonplace Book. Jot down additional reflections and thoughts in your Bible notebook or share with others.



Teacher Note

Read over the lesson plans to familiarize yourself with the content for accountability and interest. If doing the lessons together, use a picture, a map, or an engaging question to rouse students' interest before reading. You may also highlight one or two unfamiliar terms if needed. If in a classroom context, you may choose to leave larger doctrinal conversations for students to have with their parents at home.

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Term 1

WEEK 1

30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 1

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide

→ INTRO

Each year in HS, we will be reading one of the Gospels along with our study of the rest of the New Testament books. This year, we will be reading Mark along with Galatians, Philippians, and Colossians. It is helpful to be continually reminded of who Jesus is and how he interacted with people. The Gospel accounts were designed to be read many times. There will be insights gained that you would only pick up after multiple readings and by paying attention to repeated words and themes.

We will make use of the Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible notes and maps, and some Bible Project videos/articles/podcasts to help us understand what Mark and Paul are saying to their audiences. Then we can think about what new thoughts about God we gain in the process. You do not need to read all the study notes for all the verses. Pick and choose based on which verses you have questions about. Use a digital or physical notebook to record your thoughts as you work your way through the readings.

→ VIEW & NARRATE

Today, we will set the stage for reading Mark by gaining some context. Narrate silently in your head or by talking to yourself to go over the main points. Or, jot them down in your journal.

- ∞ Video Link: How to Read the New Testament
- ∞ Video Link: How to Read the Gospel
- ∞ Video Link: Mark Summary

→ PRINT

You may want to print out the summary of the book to reference as you read.
∞ Image Link: Mark

→ MAPWORK

When places are named in the text, refer to a map in the study Bible. Finding the places on the map is very helpful for seeing the stories in the context of the land. Sketching your own maps of journeys or regions can be helpful too.

• NOTE

This journal option contains only the Bible book text and space to write.

∞ Link: ESV Scripture Journal Mark

WEEK 2

30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 2

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide

→ READ

Mark 1

→ NARRATE & RESPOND

Silently or orally tell back to yourself what you read. Then, in your journal, respond to what you read by putting down some of your thoughts or questions. Just like in nature study, when we ask questions such as What did I notice? What did I wonder? Or what did this remind me of? We can ask the same questions about what we read.

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

- ∞ Podcast Link: Anointed
- Listen from 11:06-29:03 about the first verses of Mark. Jot down any thoughts afterwards.

★ NOTE

Instead of reading Mark for some of the lessons, consider watching and listening to Mark via the LUMO Project, which only uses the actual text of Mark but has people acting while it is read. There are many versions and many languages available. You might consider this resource for your modern language studies, too.

∞ Video Link: Lumo Project Mark

WEEK 3

30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 3

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ

Mark 2-3

→ NARRATE & RESPOND

Silently or orally tell back to yourself what you read. Then, in your journal, respond to what you read by putting down some of your thoughts or questions. Just like in nature study, when we ask questions such as What did I notice?, What did I wonder?, or What did this remind me of?, we can ask the same questions about what we read. Repeat this same process as you work through the lessons.

★ NOTE

The Bible Project has an app with a weekly playlist to go deeper into many topics for continued study.

∞ Info Link: Bible Project App

WEEK 4

30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 4

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Mark 4

★ NOTE

The Bible Project has an interesting podcast series on the parables if you are interested in learning more!

∞ Podcast Series Link: Decoding the Parables

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Term 1

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

∞ Video Link: How to Read the Parables

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Herod's Family Tree

WEEK 5

30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 5

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Mark 5

→ MAP WORK

Don't forget to find place names on your maps or sketch a map that shows where the events are taking place.

WEEK 6

30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 6

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Mark 6

→ READ

Look in the Chronological Guide (p.152-177) for helpful articles and in your Study Bible for verse commentary and more helpful information.
Jot down your thoughts, reflections, and observations.

WEEK 7

30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 7

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Mark 7-8

★ NOTE
Discuss with a parent or teacher what you are learning.

WEEK 8

30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 8

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Mark 9

WEEK 9

30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 9

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Mark 10

→ READ

Look in the Chronological Guide (p.152-177) for helpful articles and in your Study Bible for verse commentary and more helpful information.
Jot down your thoughts, reflections, and observations.

WEEK 10

30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 10

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

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Term 1	
→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND Mark 11	
WEEK 11 30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 11 Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide → RECAP What did you read last time? → READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND Mark 12	
WEEK 12 30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 12 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: Mark	

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Term 2

WEEK 1

30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 13

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Mark 13

→ VIEW

- ∞ Video Link: Jerusalem's Temple
- ∞ Article Link: Jerusalem and Temple Map

WEEK 2

30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 14

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Mark 14

→ LISTEN

- ∞ Podcast Link: The Exodus Way E7: Passover Psalms at the Last Supper
- Listen to the beginning about what Jesus and the disciples sang. Finish if you are interested at another time.

WEEK 3

30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 15

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Mark 15-16

→ READ

- ∞ Article Link: The Missing End of Mark's Gospel

★ NOTE

Discuss with a parent, teacher, or classmate what you are learning.

WEEK 4

30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 16

→ VIEW & NARRATE

- ∞ Video Link: How to Read the NT Letters in Historical Context
- ∞ Video Link: How to Read the NT Letters in Literary Context

→ WRITE

Jot down any notes.

WEEK 5

30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 17

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide

→ VIEW

Today, we will set the stage for reading Galatians by gaining some context specific to the book.

- ∞ Video Link: Intro to Galatians

→ PRINT

You may want to print out the summary of the book to reference as you read Galatians.

- ∞ Image Link: Galatians Summary

→ READ

This guide might be helpful to refer to as you read Galatians. It also has suggestions for further study.

- ∞ Article Link: Book of Galatians Guide

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Galatians 1

WEEK 6

30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 18

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

★ NOTE

The Bible Project has an interesting podcast series on the Letters of the NT if you are interested in learning more!

∞ **Podcast Series Link:** Letters of the NT

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Term 2		
	→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND Galatians 2	
WEEK 7	30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 19 Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide → RECAP What did you read last time? → READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND Galatians 3	
WEEK 8	30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 20 Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide → RECAP What did you read last time? → READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND Galatians 4	
WEEK 9	30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 21 Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide → RECAP What did you read last time? → READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND Galatians 5	★ NOTE Discuss with a parent, teacher, or classmate what you are learning.
WEEK 10	30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 22 Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide → RECAP What did you read last time? → READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND Galatians 6	
WEEK 11	30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 23	
WEEK 12	30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 24 <i>30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 24</i> Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course.	

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Term 3

WEEK 1	30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 25	
WEEK 2	30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 26	★ NOTE Discuss with a parent, teacher, or classmate what you are learning.
WEEK 3	30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 27	
WEEK 4	30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 28	
WEEK 5	30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 29	★ NOTE Discuss with a parent, teacher, or classmate what you are learning.
WEEK 6	30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 30	
WEEK 7	30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 31	
WEEK 8	30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 32	★ NOTE Discuss with a parent, teacher, or classmate what you are learning.
WEEK 9	30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 33	
WEEK 10	30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 34	
WEEK 11	30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 35	
WEEK 12	30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 36 30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 36 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course.	

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Examination

Term 2

• Galatians: Choose one:

- a) Tell how Paul addresses the believers in Galatia regarding faith and law. What are some ways the Gospel was being undermined?
- b) What is meant by “It is for freedom that Christ has set us free. Stand firm, then, and do not let yourselves be burdened again by a yoke of slavery” (Gal. 5:1).
- c) Discuss, “Since we live by the Spirit, let us keep in step with the Spirit” (Gal. 5:25).